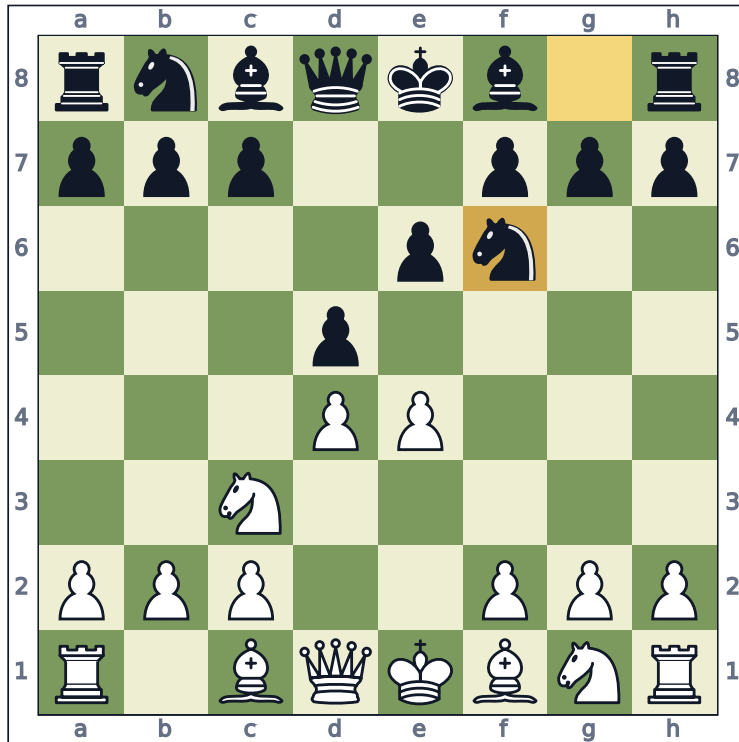


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C11 | 19 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.33 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C11 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Classical Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C11 line

This section preserves all 19 names and defining routes assigned to C11 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Classical Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6

002 French Defense: Classical Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5

003 French Defense: Classical Variation, Burn Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 dxe4

004 French Defense: Classical Variation, Burn Variation, Main Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Be7 6. Bxf6 Bxf6 7. Nf3 O-O

005 French Defense: Classical Variation, Burn Variation, Morozevich Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Be7 6. Bxf6 gxf6

006 French Defense: Classical Variation, Delayed Exchange Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. exd5

007 French Defense: Classical Variation, Shirov-Anand Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. Nce2

008 French Defense: Classical Variation, Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5

009 French Defense: Classical Variation, Swiss Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bd3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C11 line

This section preserves all 19 names and defining routes assigned to C11 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 French Defense: Henneberger Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Be3

011 French Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 a6 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. e5 Nfd7

012 French Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. Nf3

013 French Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 a6 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. e5 Nfd7 6. Ne2

014 French Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 a6 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. e5 Nfd7 6. a3

015 French Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. dxc5 Nc6

016 French Defense: Steinitz Variation, Boleslavsky Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. Nf3 Nc6 7. Be3

017 French Defense: Steinitz Variation, Bradford Attack Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. dxc5 Bxc5 7. Qg4

018 French Defense: Steinitz Variation, Brodsky-Jones Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. dxc5 Nc6 7. a3 Bxc5 8. Qg4 O-O 9. Nf3 f6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C11 line

This section preserves all 19 names and defining routes assigned to C11 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 French Defense: Steinitz Variation, Gledhill Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. Qg4